BREAKAWAY SESSION: Accelerating Electric Mobility Transition for Viksit Bharat

AN ELECTRIC TRANSFORMATION

The India Today conclave brought into focus both the urgency and complexity of India's EV transition. As government and industry leaders came together, the conversation moved beyond adoption numbers to the harder question of execution—how policy, industry and consumers must align for the shift to sustain.

Mahmood Ahmed of the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) underlined a calibrated approach, arguing that the government's role is to create a strong regulatory backbone without backing any single technology. Industry voices, including VinFast India CEO Tapan Ghosh, pointed to rapid growth but stressed that deeper localisation—especially of high-cost batteries—will be key to unlocking scale. Invest India's Sujatha U.C. echoed the point, highlighting supply chain localisation as critical to attracting investment.

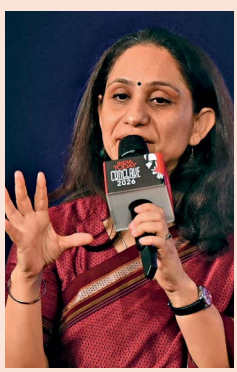
On the policy front, Delhi transport official Nidhi Sarohe identified three persistent hurdles: high vehicle costs, patchy charging infrastructure and lack of consumer confidence. Akshima Ghate of RMI India widened the lens, positioning EVs as central to India's energy security amid wars, tariffs and other supply chain shocks. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- India's mobility policy is technology-agnostic, relying on incentives and standards, not picking winners in EV vs fossil fuel debate
- Scale depends on domestic value chains. Localising high-cost components, especially batteries, is central to cutting EV costs and driving adoption
- Reducing oil dependence and exposure to external supply chain shocks is now part of the core rationale behind EVs

Photographs by HARDIK CHHABRA

AKSHIMA GHATE
Managing Director, RMI India



For a crude oil importing economy, wars and tariff shocks are really a wakeup call that we need to diversify

MAHMOOD AHMED
Additional Secretary, MoRTH



Through incentivisation, we've reached a situation where the message is loud and clear: EVs are the way forward

TAPAN GHOSH
CEO, VinFast India



Battery contributes to more than a third of vehicle cost. If we can localise production... mass adoption will follow

SUJATHA U.C.
Vice President, Invest India



We are working across sectors and looking at how to ensure return on investment for component makers

NIDHI SAROHE
Joint Commissioner, Transport, Delhi



Delhi has 4,000+ EV buses; we plan 12,000+ in 3-4 years; greater visibility on roads will build confidence in the sector